LFH Case No. 078

Bradford, Wisc.[1]
Sept. 16th 74

Friend Ettie

Hurrah for a chat!! Although you dont deserve one mite of my attention.

I am at the church as usual with only three scholars though today I've sent two of them for water & set the other playing hide & seek or snap & catch with her shadow around the stove. I've only three weeks after this tank torture.

Well how are you any way I hear that Eva is home (pg. 2) how very much I would like to see her. how long will they stay? I attended an institute last week. no, it was week before last. Had a very pleasant time. Prof. Albert Salisberry Conductor. Now you will be kind enough to over look, or look over, this wretched writing; to the Spirit which moves me to write. Now dont infer because it move my pen so crookedly that its an evil one._the flesh is weak. I worked too hard last Saturday & my hands have been stiff ever since. Indeed I worked my finger nails off; you've herd of such things but, I presume in your quiet sphere never witnessed the like. I washed & ironed & between them managed to blister every finger & make sores in the palm of my hands. But whats the use of trying to rouse your sympathies when you're so far away. I have had one letter from Ada since I came down. (pg. 3)

Does your health improve? Well I am sure it will after this. Ada writes that she has thoughts of teaching next winter.

I do not expect to go to school before next Spring. Will teach this winter, but do not intend to remain here. Have some thoughts of going to the Grove.

Has W. Paul been down to see you lately, when did you go up to Mr. P's if indeed you went at all & were the people all well & free from heart; diseases & liver affections[2].

Well I'd like to see you today it would be so much nicer to talk than write but I've found I cant always have my druthers in this world of ours.

I had a short letter from Emma H.[3] last week; she did not write me any particular news only (pg. 4) only of Mattie Anderson. Poor prospect for becoming Aunt Ettie is good? is it? I must hear a recitation

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1. Bradford, Wisconsin, is located within the Janesville, Wisconsin, city limits.
2. "Afflictions?"
3. Most likely, Emma Heacock.

Created: 02/23/2025,20:42:00; Last revised: 03/06/2025,02:55:00; Words: 1676; Char.: 7172; DOC. Size: <Document Size>; Version: <Version Numbers>.; File Name: 1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078.odt; No. of pages: 4. Path: D:\LFH\Letters\Flagler\ODT\. ©2006 by Craig G. Campbell, Author/Publisher, 2431 Highcrest Road, Rockford, IL 61107. LairdGordn@aol.com. All rights reserved. No part of this letter may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying, recording, or by any information storage and retrieval system, without written permission from the Author/Publisher. Originally transcribed 09/19/2005. **LFH Case No. 078**.

or two and then go to dinner. After noon.

I hope to get some letters tonight there ought to be four at least for me. Do Eva Sylvester & Felix think of going to Cal. this fall; if so when will they start?[4]

I expect Rei will visit me the last week of my term. Emma H. gave me an invitation to visit her. I think it is the last of this month that they are intending to have a party at their house & the invitation was to me & my attendant unfortunately he's not in this part of the country.[5] I shall have to stay at home. To bad isn't it.

The next part of the letter appears in the upper one-half margin of the first page, written with crossing letters over the first page, perpendicular to the original salutation and greeting.

I presume you will attend. If you see W. P. tell him I think of him every time it rains. how he did'nt see to come after us. But I really would like to see him. wonder if I ever shall.[6] I am writing to much to you. <u>you</u> dont deserve it. But then you are a poor sick sister & I suppose I ought to not so expect much of you. I can not write any more today.

I am going out to tea tonight. I went down to Mr. White's last night to tea you know that is where I boarded last term She is not any better. Has all the aches and pains imaginable I expect to go to Emerald Grove tonight after school.

Now Ettie when you write tell me about all the people up there. I suppose I ought to inquire about old Mr. Crofs.

When you get this don't wait till you forget who it is from.

The letter continues upside down in the upper margin of the last page.

Doubtless you are aware of the fact that I've written two or three letters to you & never recd. but one. Please remember; <u>Stationary</u> & stamps cost money. Send along your news

P.S. With love to the Femamnes[7] & respects to the mas cutines I remain your devoted friend E.[8]

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4. Sylvester and Felix S. Flagler, were brothers of Juliette A. E. Flagler. Eva Allen Flagler Was Vet's spouse. This is the first mention in the *Flagler-Campbell Epistolary* of going to California.

5. This same party is mentioned in another letter sent to Juliaette by Sarah E. Anderson. See: *1874 9 4 Letr. Sarah E. Anderson to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, #077*.

6. "W. P." William Paul perhaps.

7. Perhaps féminin(e) and the second mas cutines? Mas, masculine noun, traditional house or farm in Provence. "Cutines?"

8. Emma Thayer is the addressor based on her letter of *1874 9 20 - Letter - Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*. The paper, calligraphy and purple ink is the same for both letters. See also: *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma J. Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 062*. In this letter Emma Thayer writes, "I dare say eer this the news of my flight eastward has reached your careless ear. Well: I have taught three days like my school very much & could not ask for a nicer class. my large boys are three which numbers is to be increased by two when the term of school at Clinton closes."

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LFH Case No. 078. 16 September 1874 Letter Emma Jane Thayer, Bradford, Wisconsin to Juliaette A. E. Flagler, Milton, Wisconsin. Data: 1 letter sheet; 1 letter written; Author's sex F; 1 author; author's age 22; No env.; Cursive; Purple ink; Not embossed; blue-lined; No watermark; No letterhead; Complimentary close; No postscript; Thayer; Written Wednesday; TOD morning (And afternoon); Summer; 12.5 x 20.2 cm (5 x 8 in); 1 date; Doc. cond. fair; Legibility fair; cotton-fibre; Wotim[9]; Crossing Letters; Heading; Per. informal greeting; No separate signature line. Originally transcribed 09/19/2005.

Emma Thayer begins her letter to Juliette (Ettie) A. E. Flagler dressing-down Ettie for not writing to her. Emma is at church with three "scholars" sending two of them to water and the third to play "hide & seek or snap & catch." She adds that she only has three weeks more of this "tank torture." Emma asks how Ettie is and that she heard that Eva Allen Flagler was visiting Ettie and that she would like to see her.[10] She tells Ettie that she attended a music institute two weeks back with Prof. Albert Salisbury conductor.[11] She then implores Ettie not to complain over her "wretched writing" because she wore her fingernails off washing and ironing, something she assumes Ettie "never witnessed the like." Emma complains "whats the use of trying to rouse your sympathies when you're so far away." She adds that she received one letter from Ada "since I came down." Emma asks Ettie if her health has improved and that Ada "has thoughts" of teaching next winter.[12] Emma tells Ettie that she doesn't expect to go to school until next spring and will teach in Bradford this winter but will not remain there. She states that she is thinking of going to the "Grove." She asks Ettie if William Paul has been down to see her or if Ettie has seen him "if indeed you went at all." She asks if the Paul family were free "from heart; diseases & liver affections." Emma writes that she liked to see Ettie today because "it would be so much nicer to talk than write but I've found I cant always have my druthers in this world of ours." Emma received a short letter from Emma Heacock bearing no "particular news" except that of "poor" Mattie Anderson." Emma writes that Ettie has "poor prospect for becoming Aunt Ettie." She then has to pause her letter to hear a recitation and go to dinner.

Emma continues her letter in the "afternoon" hoping to receive to receive four letters tonight and then asks if "Eva Sylvester & Felix think of going to Cal. this fall; if so when will they start?[13] Emma tell Ettie that "Rei" will visit her the last week of her term, and that Emma Heacock gave her an invitation for a party at her house "the last of this month." "Unfortunately," she cannot attend because her "attendant" is not in "this
part of the country. I shall have to stay at home. To bad isn't it." Emma than continues in the

9. WOTIM - Written over text & in Margins.

10. Eva Allen Flagler was married to Sylvester Flagler older brother of Ettie's.

11. Albert Salisbury was a graduate of Milton College, principal at Brodhead High School (1873-1872) and conductor and later president of Whitewater Normal school which is now UW-Whitewater in Whitewater, Wisconsin. Source: 'Albert Salisbury: Whitewater Normal President and Educator.' Wisconsin Local History & Biography Articles; "*Milwaukee Free Press*"; Milwaukee, Wisconsin; 1905 02 18; viewed online at https://www.wisconsinhistory.org on 2024 06 30.

12. Ada Thayer was a younger sister of Emma. Ada was 18 years-old in 1874 (b. 1856).

13. In a letter dated 8 Sept. 1876 Emma writes about a transcontinental train trip from Wisconsin to Sonoma County, California. In the 1880 US Census for Bolinas, Marin Co., California, Emma J. Thayer is listed as a school teacher, born in Wisconsin and both parents born in Maine. This correlates with other US Census data for the Thayer family. This is the first mention in the *Flagler-Campbell Epistolary* of any Flagler family considering a trip to California. See: *1876 9 8 Letter. CA Friend, Sonoma Co., CA, To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 132*. See also: *1879 5 3 Letr. CA Friend, Olema Station, to Juliette A.E. Flagler, 186* and *1879 10 1 Letr. CA Friend, Olema Station, to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 197*. Both of these letters discuss her teaching experience in Sonoma County, California.

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LFH Case No. 078. top margin of page 1 with crossing letters over her first page, perpendicular to the main text. She assumes Ettie will attend the party and then asks Ettie to say hello to W.P. (William Paul). Emma asks Ettie to tell W. P. that she remembers him every time it rains, and wonders "if I ever shall" see him again. Emma then complains she writes "to much to you. you dont deserve it. But then you are a poor sick sister & I suppose I ought to not so expect much of you. I can not write any more today." The reference to Ettie's health is a theme that comes up in many letters written to Ettie. Emma writes that she is going out for "tea tonight" and that she had tea with Mr. White where she boarded last term. She adds that "she" (Mrs. White) "Has all the aches and pains imaginable." She says she will go to Emerald Grove tonight after school.[14] Emma concludes her letter asking Ettie to write to her "about all the people up there" and specifically mentions a Mr. Crofs; that when she receives this letter she shouldn't wait to reply and forget "who it is from"; that Emma has already written two or three letters to Ettie and received only one reply; and that Ettie should remember "stationary and stamps cost money." Her postscript says "P.S. With love to the Femamnes & respects to the 'mas' cutines I remain your devoted friend E." Originally transcribed 09/19/2005. Emma J. Thayer wrote eight letters to Juliette A. E. Flagler: *1872 4 9 Letr. Emma Thayer to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 061*; *1873 12 3 Letr. Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 62*; *1874 9 16 Letter - 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A. E. Flagler, 078*; *1875 2 22 Letr. Emma J. Thayer 'E.J.F.' to Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 095*; *1875 3 14 Letr. 'E' Emma Thayer To Juliaette A.E. Flagler, 099*; and *1874 9 20 - Letter Emma Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 536*; *1876 9 8 Letter Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 132*; and *1879 5 3 Letter - Emma J. Thayer To Juliette A. E. Flagler, 186*. All of these letters share the same syntax and narrative style.

14. Emerald Grove is an unincorporated community in the town of Bradford, Rock County, Wisconsin.

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